

One Day, Four Names

What Tokyo, Seoul, Pyongyang and Washington each decided to call 15 August 1945. And the subject every name leaves out.

終戦の日

the war ended

TOKYO

광복절

the light was restored

SEOUL

조국해방의 날

the fatherland was liberated

PYONGYANG

V-J Day

victory over Japan

WASHINGTON

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00 THE BRIEF

The war in the Pacific ended once. It has at least six official names, and none of them is neutral.

Each name is a sentence with a subject removed. Where the subject went is where the policy lives, and the grammar fixed in 1945, 1949, 1963 and 1982 still predicts the quarrels of August 2026.

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- 01** **Japan's official name for the day mentions neither the war's end nor its loss.** The cabinet decision of 13 April 1982 calls it the Day for Mourning the War Dead and Praying for Peace. [Cabinet decision, 13 Apr 1982; MHLW]
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- 02** **On 16 August 1945 Stalin accepted the order that split Korea without mentioning Korea.** In the same message he asked for the northern half of Hokkaido. Truman declined. Japan stayed whole; Korea was divided. [FRUS 1945 VI, docs 450, 452]
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- 03** **The "two colonels, thirty minutes, a National Geographic map" story merges three documents carrying two different dates.** Dean Rusk's own account in the government record has no stopwatch and no map. [FRUS 1945 VI, doc 771; Schnabel 1972; Rusk 1990]
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- 04** **Kim Il-sung reached Korea on 19 September 1945, five weeks after liberation.** In 2024, 2025 and 2026 his grandson marked the anniversary by laying wreaths for Soviet soldiers. [Rodong Sinmun, via NK News, 15 Aug 2026]
-
- 05** **On 15 August 2026 Japan's Emperor spoke of "deep remorse." The Prime Minister did not use the word.** A year earlier her predecessor had put it back after twelve years without it. [Prime Minister's Office, addresses 2012-2026; Kyodo, 15 Aug 2026]
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WHAT TO DO WITH THIS

Treat the official name of a commemoration as a primary source. Read it before the speech. The names tell you what each state needs its citizens to carry out of the room, and the 2026 speeches in Section X bear the reading out.

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The route

Five capitals, one noon. A line that was drawn and a line that was refused. Then the paper trail behind a legend, a control case from Bonn, and what the names did on 15 August 2026.

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I NOON

A voice nobody had heard, and the two words it did not say

At noon on 15 August 1945, a voice came out of Japan's radios that almost nobody listening had heard before. It belonged to the Emperor.

He read a rescript. The Empire, it said, "accepts the provisions of their Joint Declaration." The war situation, it said, had developed "not necessarily to Japan's advantage." The text does not contain the word for surrender, 降伏, or the word for defeat, 敗戦. [Imperial Rescript on the Termination of the War, 14 Aug 1945, broadcast 15 Aug]

Across the strait, in a colony that had been Japanese for thirty-five years, the same noon had a different name before the day was out. In Seoul it became 광복, the light restored. In the north, where Soviet troops had crossed the border a week earlier, the word that stuck was 해방, liberation. In Washington it was still Tuesday night, and the headline writers were already calling it V-J Day.

Eighty-one years later those names are still on the calendar. I started lining them up because I wanted a clean comparison of how four school systems teach the same date. The comparison turned out to be unnecessary. You do not need the textbooks. The names already contain the lesson.

Every name for 15 August is a sentence with the subject taken out.

Japan's war *ended*. Korea's light *was restored*. The fatherland *was liberated*. America *won*. Read them as grammar and each one tells you who is allowed to act, who is allowed to be blamed, and who is not in the sentence at all. I came to call it the missing subject, and once you see it you cannot stop seeing it, in cabinet decisions, in speeches, in a Russian law passed in 2023.

FIG. 01

One ending, six names. Each one assigns the verb to somebody, or to nobody.

The official or dominant name for the end of the Pacific war in each capital, its literal sense, and who the sentence lets act.

STATE	NAME	LITERAL SENSE	WHO ACTS
Japan cabinet decision · 1982	戦没者を追悼し平和を祈 念する日 senbotsusha o tsuitō shi heiwa o kinen suru hi	Day for mourning the war dead and praying for peace. Common usage: 終戦の日, the day the war ended.	No one. The war ends on its own.
South Korea statute · 1 Oct 1949	광복절 Gwangbokjeol	The festival of restored light. Marks both liberation in 1945 and the founding of the government in 1948.	Unstated. Light returns; the returner is not named.
North Korea state calendar	조국해방의 날 Choguk haebang-ŭi nal	Day of the liberation of the fatherland.	Kim Il-sung's guerrillas, in the official history. Since 2024, Soviet soldiers too.
United States usage · proclamation 1945	V-J Day 14 or 15 Aug; 2 Sep by proclamation	Victory over Japan. Rhode Island still keeps "Victory Day" as a legal holiday on the second Monday of August.	The United States. Korea is not in the sentence.
Russia federal law · 24 Jun 2023	День Победы над милитаристской Японией 3 September	Day of victory over militaristic Japan and the end of the Second World War. The adjective was added in 2023.	The Soviet army. Japan is named and characterised.
China statutory · 2014	中国人民抗日战争胜利纪 念日 3 September	Victory day of the Chinese people's war of resistance against Japan. The official English adds "aggression".	The Chinese people. Japan is named.

Sources: MHLW (Japan), 국경일에 관한 법률 (ROK, 1949), KCNA usage (DPRK), Truman radio address of 1 Sep 1945, Kremlin (24 Jun 2023), NPC Standing Committee (27 Feb 2014). Germany, the control case, appears in Section VIII.

What follows is the paper trail: who chose each name, when, and what they left out. Halfway through, the names stop being a matter of grammar and become a matter of territory, because the same week the names were being coined, two lines were being discussed on two maps. One was drawn. One was refused. The difference is the whole story of the peninsula.

II TOKYO

A day with no loser

For eighteen years after the broadcast, Japan had no official day for the end of the war; its first national memorial services, in 1952 and 1959, fell on other dates. It had a date everyone half-remembered and a government that had not decided what to call it.

The first fix came from the Ikeda cabinet on 14 May 1963, which set the state-hosted National Memorial Ceremony for the War Dead on 15 August. The ceremony moved into the Nippon Budokan in 1965. Before 1963, the Nikkan Kogyo Shimbun notes, the public was "not necessarily" aware which day counted as the war's end. [Cabinet decision, 14 May 1963; Nikkan Kogyo Shimbun, 産業春秋 column; Nikkei, 15 Aug 2023]

The name came nineteen years after that. On 13 April 1982 the Suzuki cabinet designated 15 August as 戦没者を追悼し平和を祈念する日, the Day for Mourning the War Dead and Praying for Peace. The Ministry of Health, Labour and Welfare, which runs the ceremony, describes its purpose as mourning the roughly 3.1 million Japanese dead of the war. [Cabinet decision, 13 Apr 1982; MHLW]

Read the name as a sentence. It contains four nouns: the war dead, mourning, peace, prayer. It does not contain 終戦, the war's ending, which is what everyone calls the day in conversation. It does not contain 敗戦, defeat, which is what the day's critics on the left call it. It does not contain aggression, colony, or any country at all.

The everyday word does its own quiet work. *Shūsen* is intransitive. The war ended, the way weather ends. *Haisen* has a loser in it. Japan's government chose neither. It chose a name in which the only people present are the Japanese dead.

CORRECTION ON THE RECORD

English-language Wikipedia states that "the National Diet enacted a law" in 1982 fixing the day. It did not. The 1982 designation was a cabinet decision, 閣議決定, not a statute. The error travels widely. Do not repeat it.

THE DEAD THE NAME COUNTS

3.1 MILLION

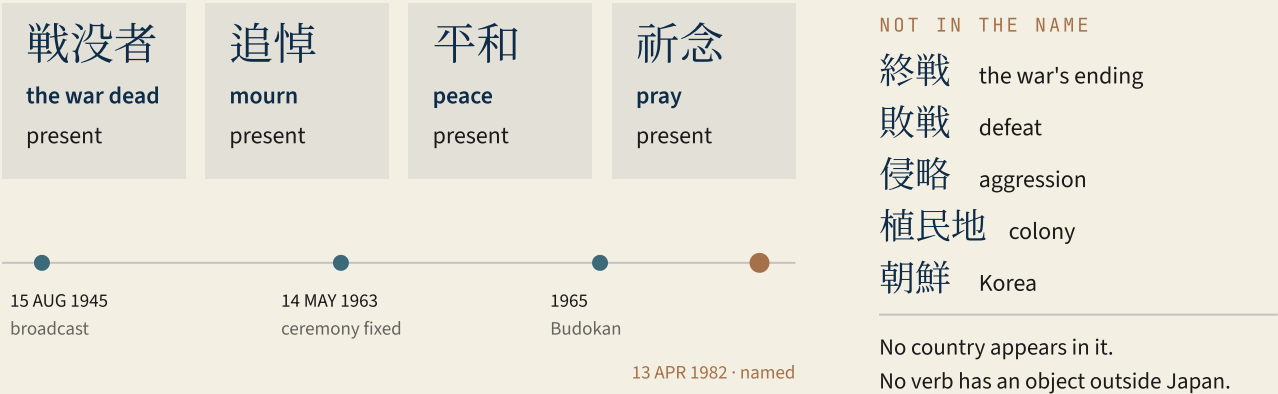
Japanese war dead mourned at the ceremony, by the former Health and Welfare Ministry's 1977 tally: about 2.3 million military personnel and civilian employees of the forces, and about 800,000 civilians. [MHLW; Nikkei, 15 Aug 2023]

FIG. 02

What the official name holds, and what it does not

The 1982 designation parsed into its four nouns, beside the words that an ending-of-war name could carry and this one does not.

戦没者を追悼し平和を祈念する日



Sources: Cabinet decisions of 14 May 1963 and 13 Apr 1982; Ministry of Health, Labour and Welfare, 全国戦没者追悼式.

The habit is older than the name. A 1967 statute on special payments to repatriates already refers to 15 August as 終戦日, the war's-end day. The official vocabulary had settled on the intransitive long before the cabinet acted; in 1982 it went one step further and dropped the ending from the name altogether. [Act on special payments to repatriates, 1967]

I will come back to Tokyo at the end, because on 15 August 2026 the Emperor and the Prime Minister stood on the same Budokan stage and used two different grammars. Hold that. In Bonn in 1985, a West German president showed that a defeated state can say its defeat out loud in an official sentence and survive it. Japan's name for the day has never tried. Section VIII is his.

First, the colony. Seoul had to name the same noon, and it put the question to a vote.

III SEOUL

The vote that picked a word

On 24 May 1949 the cabinet of the Republic of Korea, whose government was nine months old, voted for a national holiday on 15 August and called it Independence Day, 독립기념일. The National Assembly threw the name out.

The Assembly's Legislation and Judiciary Committee replaced it with 광복절, Gwangbokjeol, and the Act on National Holidays was promulgated on 1 October 1949 with that word in it. 광복 means the restoration of light. The Encyclopedia of Korean Culture defines the holiday as marking two things at once: the recovery of sovereignty on 15 August 1945 and the establishment of the government on 15 August 1948. [Dong-A Ilbo, 27 May 1949; 국경일에 관한 법률, 1 Oct 1949; Encyclopedia of Korean Culture, AKS]

The grammar is restorative. Something that already existed, the nation's sovereignty, came back. The name does not say who brought it. The word the cabinet wanted, independence, is closer to a founding. Read as grammar, the Assembly chose recovery over birth, and in doing so it handed the Republic a question it has been arguing about for seventy-seven years.

When does the Republic of Korea begin? Conservatives and the historians of the New Right answer 15 August 1948, when the government was formed, and have campaigned to rename the day 건국절, Founding Day. Progressives and the independence-movement associations answer 1919, when the Provisional Government was proclaimed in Shanghai after the March First uprising. They point to the Constitution's preamble, which speaks of "upholding the cause of the Provisional Republic of Korea Government born of the March First Independence Movement of 1919."

THE YEAR ON THE PAPER

30TH YEAR

Two 1948 speeches by the new government's leaders were dated 대한민국 30년, Year 30 of the Republic of Korea, counting from 1919. The 1948 Constitution itself used the Dangun calendar. [Seoul Shinmun, 18 Aug 2016]

A DISPUTED CLAIM

Historian Han Si-jun of Dankook University told Seoul Shinmun that the word 건국, founding, "does not even exist in the stenographic records of the Constituent Assembly" of 1948. The record does contain it, in a telegram read into the session of 3 June 1948. [Seoul Shinmun, 18 Aug 2016; Constituent Assembly record]

FIG. 03

Where does the Republic begin? One holiday, two birthdays, three dates.

The three anchors in the founding dispute, and which camp fastens the Republic to which.



Sources: Constitution of the Republic of Korea, preamble; Encyclopedia of Korean Culture (AKS); Seoul Shinmun, 18 Aug 2016.

The fight has a legislative history. Representative Chung Kap-yoon of the Grand National Party filed a bill in the 17th National Assembly to rename the holiday Founding Day; it lapsed, was refiled in July 2008 and was then withdrawn. In 2008 the Lee Myung-bak government marked "sixty years since founding," and fourteen historical associations, including the Korean Modern and Contemporary History Association, issued a statement against the rename. The dispute flared again in 2024 over the appointment of a new director at the Independence Hall, when independence-activist groups boycotted the official ceremony. [Hankyoreh, 12 Sep 2008; Hankook Ilbo, 13 Aug 2008; JoongAng Daily, 15 Aug 2024]

None of this is a quarrel about 1945. Everyone in Seoul agrees the light came back that day. The quarrel is about the sentence's missing subject: whether the Republic is the thing that was restored, or the thing that was built afterwards on American-administered ground. That question points north, where the other half of the peninsula answered it with a single name and a single man.

IV PYONGYANG

The month between the liberation and the liberator

North Korea's name for the day has a verb with an object in it. 조국해방의 날: the day of the liberation of the fatherland. Somebody liberated somebody. The official history says who.

In the DPRK account, the Korean People's Revolutionary Army under Kim Il-sung played the leading role in the country's liberation, with the Soviet army in a secondary one. [Official DPRK historiography, as summarised by HRNK, 2021]

The record runs on a different clock. The Soviet Union declared war on Japan on 8 August 1945. The 25th Army under Colonel General Ivan Chistyakov moved into northern Korea. Soviet landing forces took Wonsan on 21 August. Airborne troops came down at Hamhŭng and Pyongyang on 24 August (some histories give the 25th), and 25th Army headquarters was set up in Pyongyang on 26 August. [University of Washington, study of Kim Il Sung and the DPRK-USSR-PRC triangle]

Kim Il-sung was not there for any of it. Since 1942 he had been a captain in the Red Army's 88th Separate Rifle Brigade near Khabarovsk. He landed at Wonsan on 19 September 1945, aboard a Soviet ship, with several dozen other Korean officers of the brigade. His first public appearance was a mass rally in Pyongyang on 14 October. [University of Washington; HRNK]

That is a fact about September 1945, not a verdict on the man. Kim's guerrilla record against the Japanese in Manchuria in the 1930s is real; it is how he came to be in a Soviet brigade in the first place. The point is narrower. The liberation and the liberator were five weeks apart, and the name closes the gap.

THE GAP

35 DAYS

From Japan's surrender broadcast on 15 August 1945 to Kim Il-sung's landing at Wonsan on 19 September. Soviet troops had held Pyongyang for 26 of those days.

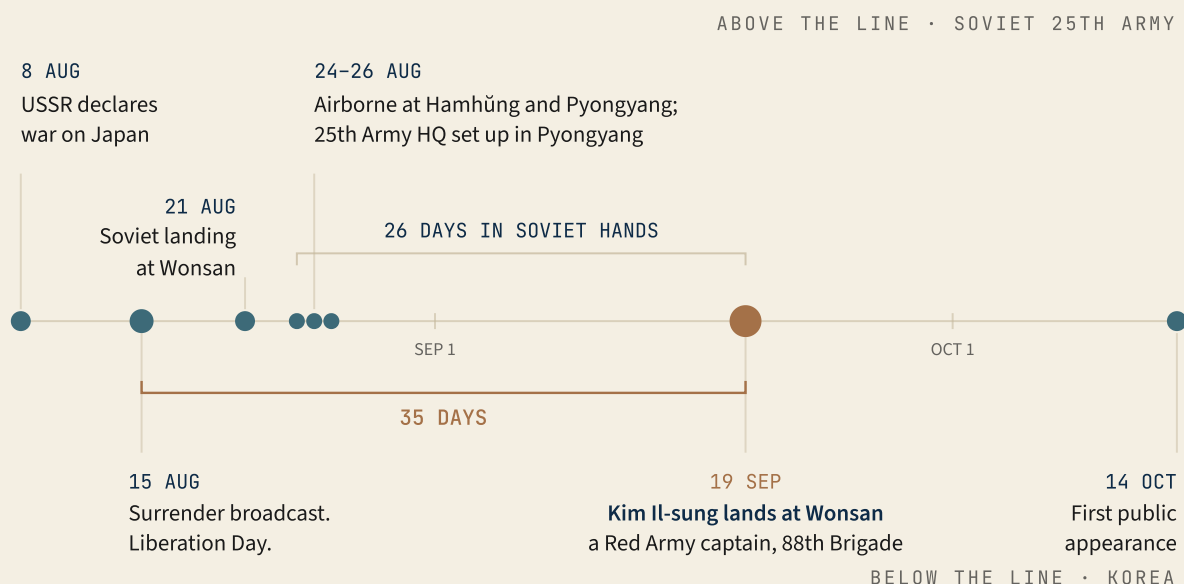
WHAT HRNK RECORDS

"Kim Il-sung and his guerilla units did not participate in the final offensive for the liberation of the country." [HRNK Insider, Apr 2021]

FIG. 04

Sixty-seven days in 1945: when the north was liberated, and when the liberator arrived

Dated events from the Soviet declaration of war to Kim Il-sung's first public appearance. One bronze mark carries the story.



Sources: University of Washington study of Kim Il-sung and the DPRK-USSR-PRC triangle; HRNK Insider (2021). Days to scale. Above the axis: Soviet operations. Below it: Korea.

Then, in 2024, the liturgy moved. On or around 15 August that year, and again in 2025 and 2026, Kim Jong Un laid wreaths at the Liberation Tower in Pyongyang, the monument to Soviet soldiers. In 2026 his wife and daughter stood beside him. Putin's message that day, as Reuters reported it, said the two countries' bond was forged as Soviet soldiers fought against Japan, and the Russian training ship *Pallada* was tied up at Wonsan for the holiday. [Rodong Sinmun, via NK News, 15 Aug 2026;

KCNA, via Reuters, 15 Aug 2026; SBS, Aug 2026]

My reading, and it is a reading: with North Korean troops in Russia's war, sharing the credit for 1945 has become useful, and for the first time in decades the regime's own ceremony gives the Soviet liberator a place of honour next to the Korean one, though Kim also honoured the first-generation revolutionaries at Daesongsan. The name has not changed. The subject standing beside it has.

V WASHINGTON AND MOSCOW

A victory without a colony

The American name is the only one of the six that cannot agree with itself about the date.

V-J Day is 14 August 1945 in Washington, the Tuesday evening Truman announced Japan's acceptance. It is 15 August in Asia. And it is 2 September, when the Instrument of Surrender was signed on the deck of USS *Missouri*; Truman's radio address of 1 September proclaimed that date the official one. Rhode Island, alone among the states, still keeps a legal holiday called Victory Day on the second Monday of August. [Truman, radio address, 1 Sep 1945; Rhode Island General Laws]

Whatever the date, the grammar is the same. Victory over Japan has a winner and a loser, named, in that order. It has no third party. Korea, whose liberation was the practical result of the victory for nearly twenty-six million people, is not in the sentence. That absence will matter in the next section.

Moscow's name is younger than it looks. In 2020 Russia moved its Day of Military Glory from 2 September to 3 September as the Day of the End of the Second World War. Then, on 24 June 2023, Putin signed a law renaming it the Day of Victory over Militaristic Japan and the End of the Second World War. The bill's explanatory note called it a response to the "unfriendly campaign" Tokyo had "unleashed" against Russia "in coordination with the collective West" after February 2022. Japan's Chief Cabinet Secretary, Hirokazu Matsuno, called the change "extremely regrettable." [Federal Law 126-FZ, 24 Apr 2020; Kremlin, 24 Jun 2023; the bill's explanatory note, via RFE/RL; Malay Mail, 26 Jun 2023]

YEARS LATE

78

YEARS

Between the end of the war and the adjective. Russia's is the only one of the six names that, in its own language, carries a word of moral characterisation, and it was added in 2023 for reasons that had nothing to do with 1945.

BEIJING'S DATE

China marks 3 September, the day after the *Missouri* signing, as the Victory Day of the Chinese People's War of Resistance against Japan; the official English adds "aggression". The Standing Committee of the National People's Congress made it statutory on 27 February 2014.

FIG. 05

Four dates for one ending

Which day each capital marks, and what it calls it. The proclaimed American date is outlined.

	14 AUG Washington time	15 AUG broadcast, Asia time	2 SEP Missouri signing	3 SEP day after
Japan		Mourning the war dead		
South Korea		Gwangbokjeol		
North Korea		Liberation of the fatherland		
United States	V-J Day, usage		V-J Day, proclaimed	
Russia				Victory over militaristic Japan
China				Victory Day

Japan and both Koreas keep the day of the broadcast. Washington marks 2 September; Moscow and Beijing, the 3rd.

Sources: Truman radio address, 1 Sep 1945; Rhode Island General Laws; Kremlin, 24 Jun 2023; NPC Standing Committee, 27 Feb 2014. Federal Law 126-FZ of 24 Apr 2020 moved Russia's date from 2 to 3 September.

The American and Russian names also settle, by assertion, a question historians have not settled: what ended the war. Tsuyoshi Hasegawa's *Racing the Enemy* argues that the Soviet declaration of 8 August shocked Tokyo into surrender more than the two bombs did; Sadao Asada and Richard Frank argue the bombs were decisive. Washington's name centres the victory, Moscow's centres the Soviet army, and Tokyo's official name declines to say what ended anything. The names took sides decades before the archives opened. [Hasegawa, *Racing the Enemy*, 2005; Asada, *Pacific Historical Review*, 1998; Frank, *Downfall*, 1999]

Six names, then, and one thing none of them says. Nobody's name for the end of the war in Asia mentions what happened to the land in between the winner and the loser. For that you have to leave the calendars and go to the cables, and in particular to one message Stalin sent on 16 August 1945, the day after the broadcast, about two islands at once.

VI THE LINE THEY DREW, AND THE ONE THEY DID NOT

Stalin's message of 16 August 1945, read closely

"Principally I have no objection against the contents of the order keeping in view that the Liaotung Peninsula is a composite part of Manchuria." That is Stalin to Truman, the day after the broadcast, accepting General Order No. 1. The order put the 38th parallel on the map of Korea. The message does not mention Korea.

It mentions two other things. First, the Kuril Islands, which Stalin wanted included in the Soviet surrender zone. Second, Hokkaido. He asked that the Soviet zone take in "the Northern part of the Island Hokkaido," with a demarcation line "leading from the city Kushiro on the Eastern coast of the island to the city Rumoe [Rumoi] on the Western coast," both cities on the Soviet side. [FRUS 1945 VI, doc 450]

He gave a reason, and the reason is worth reading because it is a sentence with a subject in it. "The Japanese in 1919–1921 held under occupation of their troops the whole Soviet Far East. The Russian public opinion would be seriously offended if the Russian troops would not have an occupation region in some part of the Japanese proper territory." [FRUS 1945 VI, doc 450]

Truman's reply, filed on 17 August and dated the 18th in Stalin's response, gave him the Kurils, with a request for an air base there, but not Hokkaido: "[A]rrangements have been made for the surrender of Japanese forces on all the islands of Japan proper, Hokkaido, Honshu, Shekoku [sic], and Kyushu, to General MacArthur." Stalin wrote back on 22 August that he understood this as a refusal. Byrnes later noted that the Hokkaido passage "was written at the White House." [FRUS 1945 VI, docs 452, 470, 476]

So in one exchange of cables the question of partitioning the defeated power was raised, argued on the merits of history and public feeling, and refused. In the same exchange, the partition of the defeated power's colony was accepted without a word.

THE LINE THAT WAS REFUSED

Kushiro to Rumoi, cutting Hokkaido roughly in half. Sapporo would have been south of it, Soviet troops north of it, and Japan would have had a 38th parallel of its own.

THE LINE THAT WAS DRAWN

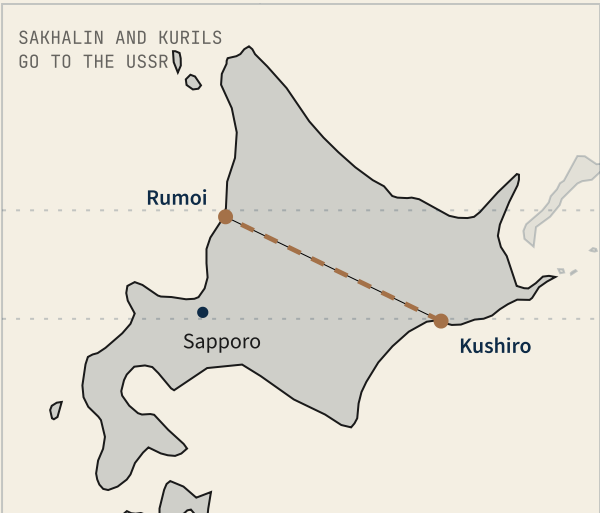
The 38th parallel north, named in paragraph 1 of General Order No. 1 as the boundary between Japanese forces surrendering to the Soviets and to the Americans. MacArthur's Proclamation No. 1 then established "military control over Korea south of 38 degrees north latitude." [FRUS 1945 VI, doc 776]

FIG. 06

Two lines proposed in the same week of August 1945. The one on the aggressor was refused. The one on the colony was accepted without comment.

Left: the Kushiro–Rumoi line Stalin requested across Hokkaido on 16 August, and the cables that refused it. Right: the 38th parallel in General Order No. 1, which Stalin accepted in the same message.

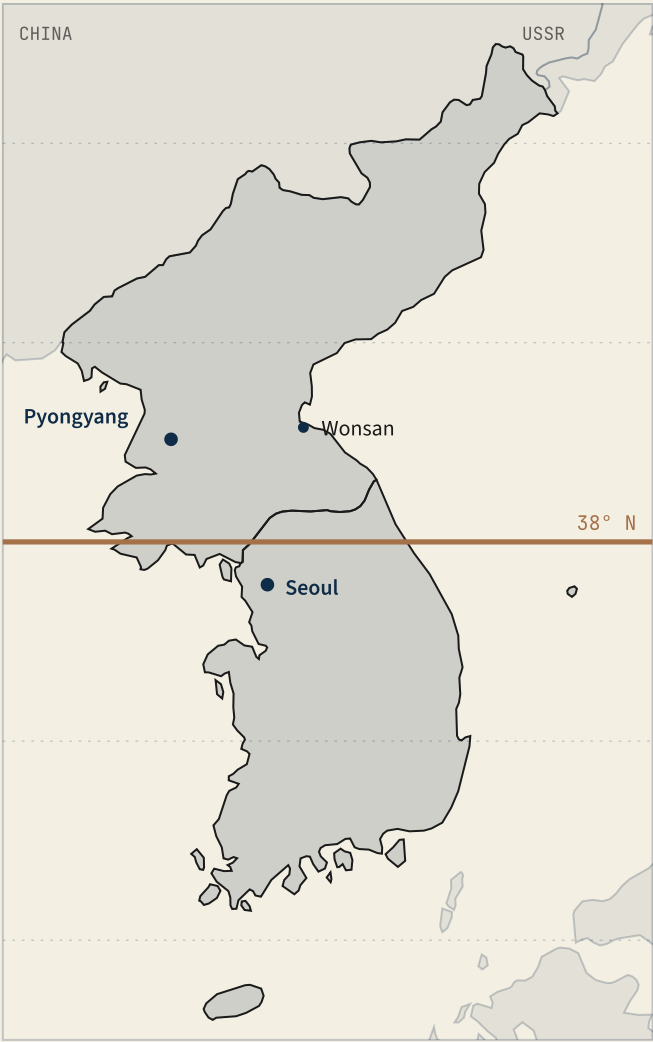
HOKKAIDO · REQUESTED · REFUSED



THE CABLES

- 16 AUG · STALIN TO TRUMAN
Accepts General Order No. 1.
Asks for Hokkaido north of Kushiro–Rumoi.
Does not mention Korea.
- 17–18 AUG · TRUMAN TO STALIN
The Kurils, yes. All of Hokkaido
surrenders to MacArthur.
- 22 AUG · STALIN TO TRUMAN
Reads it as: "you refuse."
Hokkaido stays whole.

KOREA · GENERAL ORDER No. 1 · ACCEPTED



Soviets take the surrender north of 38°,
Americans south. No Korean was consulted.
Coastlines: Natural Earth 1:50m

Sources: FRUS 1945 VI, docs 450, 452, 470; General Order No. 1. Equirectangular; panels are not to a common scale.

In Europe they divided the aggressor. In Asia they divided the colony.

That sentence needs its qualifiers stated plainly, so that nobody can knock it down with them. Germany's division was not decided in a week; it hardened out of four occupation zones over four years. Japan did lose territory: southern Sakhalin and the Kurils to the Soviet Union, and Okinawa to American administration until 1972. Austria, part of the Reich, was occupied in four zones and left whole in 1955. Nor was the 38th parallel meant as a punishment: by Rusk's own account it was drawn to keep the surrender of Seoul in American hands. [Austrian State Treaty, 15 May 1955; Okinawa Reversion Agreement, 1971]

None of that changes the ledger. The home islands of the state that ran the empire were never cut into zones. The peninsula the empire had held for thirty-five years was cut on a line no Korean had been asked about, and the division has held, with one war across it, for eighty-one years. [Cumings, The Origins of the Korean War, vol. 1]

FIG. 07

The partition ledger, 1945 to the present

Who was the aggressor, who was the colony, and whose territory was cut.

COUNTRY	ROLE IN 1945	OUTCOME
Germany	Aggressor	Four occupation zones. Two states from 1949. Reunified 1990.
Austria	Annexed participant	Four zones, one government. Sovereign by the State Treaty of 1955.
Japan	Aggressor	Home islands never partitioned. US-led occupation 1945 to 1952. Lost southern Sakhalin and the Kurils (the southern four disputed). Okinawa under US administration to 1972.
Korea	Colony	Divided at 38° N in August 1945. Two states from 1948. War 1950 to 1953. Still divided.

Sources: FRUS 1945 VI; Austrian State Treaty (1955); Okinawa Reversion Agreement (1971); Treaty of San Francisco (1951).

Six states named the day. The one country partitioned by the day's settlement is in none of the six names except its own two, and even those do not say who drew the line. The line was drawn by two American colonels in a room in Washington, and most of what you have heard about that night is assembled from three documents that do not agree.

VII THREE SOURCES, TWO DATES

Taking the legend apart, document by document

The version everyone repeats goes like this: two colonels, Dean Rusk and Charles Bonesteel, were given thirty minutes, late on the night of 10 August 1945, found a National Geographic map, and picked the 38th parallel. Every element in that sentence is sourced. No single source contains all of them.

Document one is Rusk's memorandum of 12 July 1950, written for the State Department's historian and printed in the Foreign Relations series. He places the meeting in John McCloy's office "on, I believe, the night of August 10–11." McCloy asked Bonesteel and him "to retire to an adjoining room and come up with a proposal which would harmonize the political desire to have U.S. forces receive the surrender as far north as possible and the obvious limitations on the ability of the U.S. forces to reach the area." They chose the 38th parallel, "even though it was further north than could be realistically reached by U.S. forces in the event of Soviet disagreement," because it kept Seoul on the American side. Rusk was "somewhat surprised that the Soviet accepted." There is no time limit in the memorandum and no map. Rusk adds a line most retellings drop: "The above is based on memory and not on documents." [FRUS 1945 VI, doc 771, editorial note quoting Rusk to Noble, 12 Jul 1950]

Document two is Rusk's memoir, forty years later. "During a meeting on August 14, 1945," he writes, Bonesteel and he "retired to an adjacent room late at night and studied intently a map of the Korean peninsula." Then: "Using a National Geographic map, we looked just north of Seoul for a convenient dividing line but could not find a natural geographical line. We saw instead the thirty-eighth parallel." The map arrives here, and so does a date three or four days later than the one in the government record. [Rusk, As I Saw It, 1990, as quoted by National Geographic, 2013]

WHERE EACH PIECE COMES FROM

August 10–11
Rusk, 1950, in FRUS.

An adjoining room, the capital kept south
Rusk, 1950, in FRUS.

A National Geographic map
Rusk, 1990 memoir, which dates the night 14 August.

Thirty minutes
Schnabel, US Army official history, 1972, about Bonesteel alone.

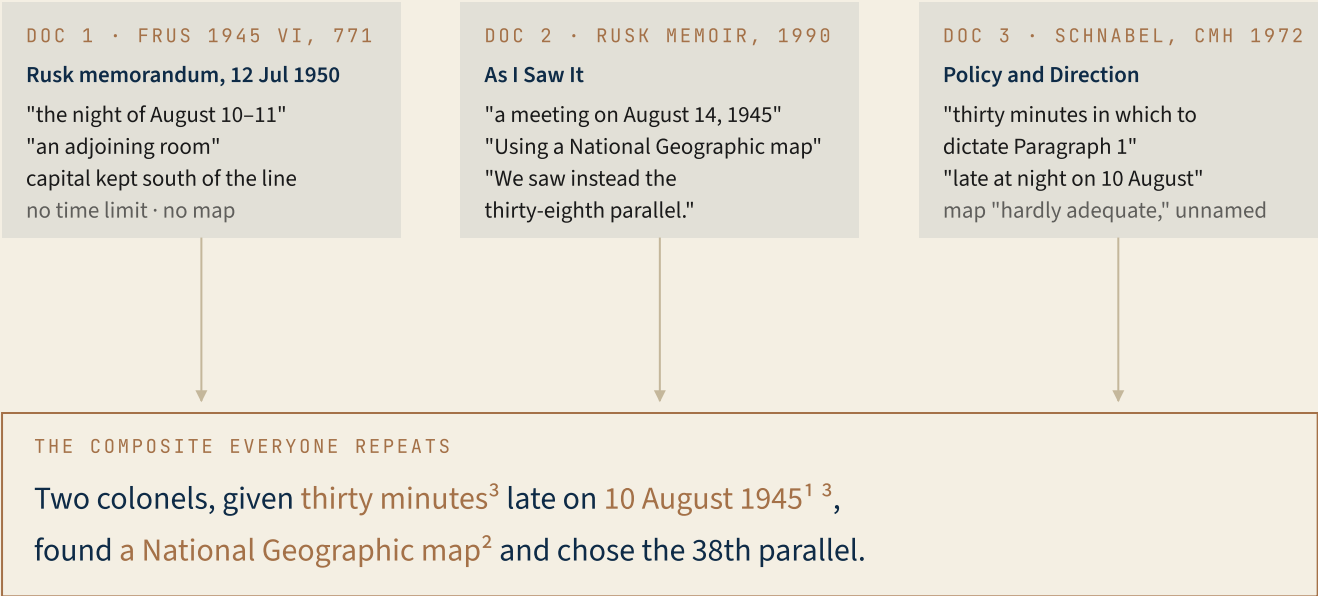
A 1904 National Geographic map
No reliable source. Hobbyist forums. Drop it.

Document three is the US Army's official history of the Korean War's first year, written by James Schnabel and published in 1972. Here is the stopwatch. Bonesteel "had thirty minutes in which to dictate Paragraph 1 to a secretary." Work began "late at night on 10 August." Schnabel says "the only map he had in his office was hardly adequate," and does not name a publisher. The draft reached the Joint Planners "in the pre-dawn hours of 11 August," where Admiral M. B. Gardner proposed the 39th parallel instead and was overruled by Brigadier General Lincoln and Assistant Secretary Dunn, who held to the 38th. [Schnabel, Policy and Direction: The First Year, CMH 1972, pp. 9–10]

FIG. 08

Anatomy of a legend: three documents, one composite sentence

Each clause of the familiar version traced to the document that supplies it. The two dates are both Rusk's.



Superscripts name the document behind each bronze clause. Rusk's two accounts differ by three or four days.

Sources: FRUS 1945 VI, doc 771; Rusk, As I Saw It (1990); Schnabel, Policy and Direction (1972). A Review of Korean Studies article argues the line was conceived around 25 July at Potsdam; noted as scholarly dissent.

Tell it in three attributed pieces and it is still a remarkable story. Tell it as one sentence and a hostile reader can take the sentence apart in an afternoon. The missing subject of the legend is the archive itself, and it is there to be read.

VIII BONN, 8 MAY 1985

The man who kept both words

Forty years after the German surrender, the Federal President stood in the Bundestag and did something no Japanese government has put into the name of 15 August. He said the word for defeat out loud, and then he added a second word without removing the first.

Early in the speech, Richard von Weizsäcker refused celebration: "Der 8. Mai ist für uns Deutsche kein Tag zum Feiern." May 8 is not a day of celebration for us Germans. He named the pain of "the complete defeat of their own fatherland," *die vollständige Niederlage*. And then the sentence the speech is remembered for: "Der 8. Mai war ein Tag der Befreiung. Er hat uns alle befreit von dem menschenverachtenden System der nationalsozialistischen Gewaltherrschaft." May 8 was a day of liberation. It freed us all from the inhuman system of National Socialist tyranny. [Weizsäcker, Bundestag address, 8 May 1985, official text]

He did one more thing with grammar. "Schuld oder Unschuld eines ganzen Volkes gibt es nicht. Schuld ist, wie Unschuld, nicht kollektiv, sondern persönlich." There is no guilt or innocence of a whole people. Guilt, like innocence, is personal. The subject of that sentence is each German, individually, and none of them is let out of it. [Weizsäcker, 8 May 1985]

Two cautions, both on the record. Weizsäcker did not coin "Tag der Befreiung." East Germany had used it officially for decades, and West German figures had used versions of it before him. His contribution was to carry the phrase into the Federal Republic's mainstream from the presidency. And the speech came three days after Chancellor Kohl and President Reagan laid a wreath at the Bitburg military cemetery, a visit that, as the Institut für Zeitgeschichte puts it in presenting its edition of the 1985 foreign-policy files, caused indignation above all in the United States, while Weizsäcker's speech was acclaimed internationally.

[Institut für Zeitgeschichte, on Akten zur Auswärtigen Politik der Bundesrepublik Deutschland 1985]

THREE WORDS, ONE SPEECH

Niederlage, defeat. Kept.

Befreiung, liberation. Added, with Germans among the liberated.

Schuld, guilt. Made personal, which is to say, given a subject.

THE ASYMMETRY

In Europe the aggressor's liberation was from its own regime, at home. In Asia the liberation that 15 August names happened in somebody else's country, which the aggressor had colonised. There is no Japanese "Befreiung" to add, because the thing liberated was Korea.

FIG. 09

Two words at once, or neither

What the two aggressor states' official memory of the war's end contains. Bonn, from 1985, keeps the defeat and adds the liberation. Tokyo's 1982 name removes the ending and the defeat and substitutes mourning.

GERMANY · WEIZSÄCKER, 8 MAY 1985

Niederlage defeat · named, kept
Befreiung liberation · added, Germans included
Schuld guilt · personal, never collective

Both words held at once.
The subject of guilt is each person.

● present ○ absent bronze: the word added in 1985

JAPAN · CABINET DECISION, 13 APR 1982

終戦 · 敗戦 ending · defeat · both absent from the name
追悼 mourning · present, of Japan's own dead
平和 peace · present, as a prayer, with no object

Neither word present.
The only people in the name are the dead.

Sources: Bundestag, official text of the 8 May 1985 address; Cabinet decision of 13 Apr 1982 (MHLW).

I am not arguing that Japan should have copied Bonn. The two cases are different in the way the aside on the previous page describes, and a German sentence does not translate into a Japanese one by swapping the nouns. I am making a smaller point. Weizsäcker proved that a defeated state can put both the defeat and the liberation into one official sentence and survive it politically. Japan's official name, three years earlier, had chosen to put neither.

That choice was made in April 1982. Ten weeks later, the textbooks blew up.

IX 1982

The headline was wrong. The practice was real.

On 26 June 1982 Japan's major papers, Asahi among them, reported that the Ministry of Education had forced a high-school history textbook to change Japan's "invasion" of North China, 侵略, to an "advance," 進出. Seoul and Beijing protested. The story is still told that way, and it is half true.

On 28 July the Sankei Shimbun reported that the passage had read 日本軍が華北に進出すると before screening as well, and on 30 July the ministry told the Diet it could find no case where a manuscript's 華北侵略 had been changed to 華北進出 in screening. On 7 September Sankei printed a front-page correction and apology. On 19 September Asahi defended its reporting overall but wrote that "even if only in part, we must apologize to our readers for having made a mistake," and asked whether the essence did not lie in the ministry's screening stance.

[Sankei, 28 Jul, 7 Sep; Diet, 30 Jul; Asahi, 19 Sep 1982; Shoji 2018]

Here is the half that was right. The media scholars Satō Takumi and Fukuma Yoshiaki conclude that the report was mistaken for the China front specifically. Fukuma adds that "invasion" became "advance" for Southeast Asia in the same cycle, and that the March First Movement of 1919, Korea's independence uprising, was rewritten as a "riot," 暴動. Asahi's larger claim was that the ministry had been pushing 侵略 out of textbooks since around 1955, the practice the Ienaga lawsuits contested. [Satō; Fukuma]

The consequences did not wait for the correction. On 26 August 1982 Chief Cabinet Secretary Miyazawa Kiichi issued a statement acknowledging that Japan's actions had "caused tremendous suffering and damage" to the peoples of Asia, and a Neighbouring Countries Clause was written into the screening standards. The response followed a report whose headline example was wrong, about a practice that was real. [Miyazawa statement, 26 Aug 1982; MOFA Diplomatic Bluebook 1983]

HOW BOTH SIDES CITE IT

The journalist Sakurai Yoshiko wrote in April 2001 that only Sankei corrected the story. Asahi's partial apology of 19 September 1982 says otherwise.

In March 2001 Education Minister Machimura Nobutaka called the 1982 report 天下の大誤報, a colossal misreport, in the Diet. True for the China example; not for Southeast Asia, as the ministry itself told the Diet that May, or for the March First Movement. [Diet record, 23 May 2001]

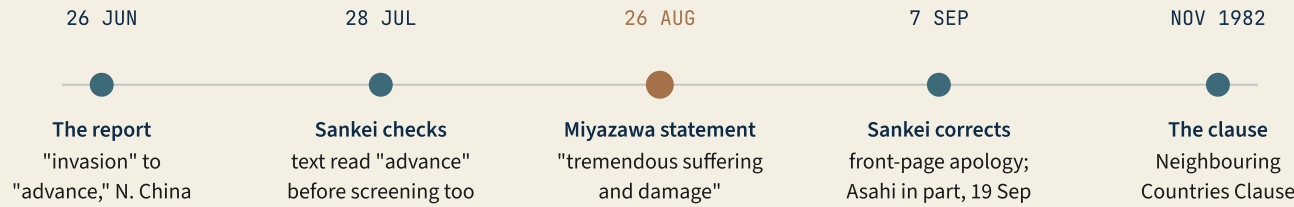
THE USABLE SENTENCE

The headline example was wrong. The practice was real. Neither "it was a hoax" nor "Japan rewrote invasion as advance in 1982" survives cross-examination on its own.

FIG. 10

The 1982 chain: a report, a correction, and the policy that followed

Dated steps from the first headline to the Neighbouring Countries Clause.



WHAT THE RECORD SUPPORTS

The North China example was wrong. Changes of "invasion" to "advance" were made for Southeast Asia in the same cycle, and the March First Movement was rewritten as a "riot." Miyazawa's statement preceded the correction.

Sources: Sankei Shimbun (28 Jul, 7 Sep 1982); Diet record (30 Jul 1982); Asahi Shimbun (19 Sep 1982); Satō Takumi and Fukuma Yoshiaki; MOFA Diplomatic Bluebook 1983; Shoji, Japan Review (2018).

The practice has not stopped; it has changed vocabulary. On 24 March 2026 the Ministry of Education approved the high-school textbooks that will be used from 2027. Most politics and geography texts carry the claim to Dokdo, which Japan calls Takeshima; a geography text from Ninomiya Shoten, approved the year before, already describes Korea's "illegal occupation." Kyodo reported that the government's positions "appear to have permeated" the books without any screening comment requiring them, which is a description of self-censorship. On wartime labour, a cabinet-approved written answer of 27 April 2021 called 強制連行, forced taking, "not appropriate" and 徴用, requisition, the suitable term; the books have followed it. Seoul summoned Japan's deputy chief of mission, Matsuo Hirotaka, protested strongly and expressed "strong regret." [MEXT, 24 Mar 2026; Kyodo; Seoul Shinmun, 24

Mar 2026; Seoul Economic Daily, 24-25 Mar 2026; ROK MOFA]

Which brings the names up to the present, and to the one day a year when four of them are spoken aloud.

X 15 AUGUST 2026

What the names did this year

At the Budokan, Prime Minister Sanae Takaichi spoke first, and the word was not there. After the noon silence, Emperor Naruhito spoke again of "deep remorse."

Her address did not mention aggression or colonial rule. It described Japan as "a nation that values peace," the Abe and Suga wording; Kishida and Ishiba had said "peaceful nation." A year earlier, on the eightieth anniversary, Shigeru Ishiba had used 反省, remorse, in the address, the first prime minister to do so since 2012. Under Abe, from 2013, remorse and the acknowledgement of harm done to Asian countries both disappeared from the speech. In 2026 the word lasted one year. [Prime Minister's Office, addresses of 2012, 2025 and 2026; Kyodo, 15 Aug 2026]

Takaichi did not go to Yasukuni. She sent a privately funded *tamagushi* offering as president of the Liberal Democratic Party, and Jiji and Kyodo reported that she bowed toward the shrine from the Budokan's car park. Four ministers went in person, among them her defence minister, Shinjirō Koizumi, the first sitting defence minister to do so on 15 August since 2024. At least one cabinet minister has now visited on the day every year since 2020. The last prime minister to visit on 15 August was Koizumi's father, in 2006. Seoul said it "cannot but deplore" the "anachronistic acts that have forgotten history." Beijing protested.

[Jiji; Kyodo; Aju News, 15 Aug 2026; Manila Bulletin, 16 Aug 2026]

Read it as grammar. The Emperor's sentence had a subject that felt remorse. The Prime Minister's sentence had a nation that valued peace, which is the 1982 name restated as a speech: no defeat, and no victims outside Japan.

FOUR MINISTERS

Jiji, Kyodo and NHK named four ministers who visited Yasukuni on 15 August 2026, which Jiji called "the first time in six years": Koizumi; Kikawada Hitoshi, minister for Okinawa and the Northern Territories; Kiuchi Minoru; and Onoda Kimi.

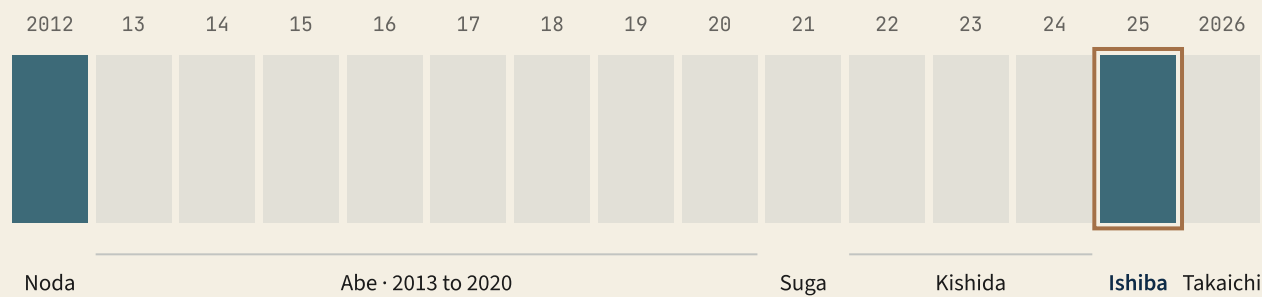
"SKIPPED YASUKUNI"

Incomplete. The Prime Minister sent an offering and, by two wire services' accounts, performed worship from a distance. The headline and the record are not the same sentence.

FIG. 11

The word "remorse" in the Prime Minister's 15 August address, 2012 to 2026

Whether 反省 appeared in the address to the National Memorial Ceremony. Two addresses in fifteen: 2012 and 2025.



Filled: the word is present. Empty: absent. Outlined: 2025, restored on the eightieth anniversary.
On the same stage in 2025 and 2026, the Emperor spoke of "deep remorse" both years.

Sources: Prime Minister's Office (kantei.go.jp), addresses to the National Memorial Ceremony for the War Dead; Kyodo (15 Aug 2026) on the 2013 to 2024 record. Legible in grayscale by fill and outline.

In Seoul the same day, President Lee Jae-myung proposed talks to formally end the Korean War and replace the 1953 armistice with a peace regime, among the two Koreas and the United States, or those three and China, and called for "a new sixty years" with Japan. A year earlier he had pledged no absorption and no hostile acts toward the North, and called the day "the day we reclaimed the freedom and the right to determine our own future." [Korea.net; JoongAng Daily; Japan Times, 15 Aug 2026; Korea Herald, 15 Aug 2025]

In Pyongyang, Kim Jong Un laid his third consecutive wreath at the Liberation Tower, Putin's message, as Reuters reported it, tied the bond to the Soviet soldiers who fought Japan, and the *Pallada* sat in Wonsan harbour, the port where Kim Il-sung had come ashore eighty-one years earlier. [NK News; Reuters, 15 Aug 2026]

Three capitals, one anniversary, and each speech did what its name predicted.

Tokyo mourned its own dead and prayed for a peace with no object, which is the 1982 designation read aloud. Seoul turned to the business the restoration never settled: how the war across the line ends. Pyongyang said liberation and, for the third year, pointed at the Soviet soldiers who did it. Washington was not on any of these stages; V-J Day names the victory over Japan, and Korea is not in it.

This is what the missing subject is for. A commemoration's official name is not a label on a date. It is the shortest policy document a state publishes, and it is republished every year, rarely amended. Japan's official name has never had a loser in it. Russia's acquired an adjective in 2023. Korea's two names have carried the same two gaps since 1949: who restored the light, and who drew the line through it.

Hence the reading rule beside this column. In 2025 a subject came back into the Japanese address, for one year. In 2026 it left again, on the same stage, in front of the same Emperor who had kept it.

My own view, and it is a view: the only names that put Korea in the sentence are Korea's own, and neither says who did the liberating or who did the dividing. Until a Korean name for the day can hold both subjects at once, the way Weizsäcker's one sentence held both defeat and liberation, the peninsula's calendar will keep telling its people half of what happened to them.

The war ended at noon. Who ended it, who was freed, and who was cut in half are three different sentences, and eighty-one years on, no state has agreed to say all three.

J.J. · VICTORIA, BRITISH COLUMBIA · 3 OCTOBER 2026

CLAIMS THIS BRIEFING DOES NOT MAKE

That Kim Il-sung "won the Second World War": the DPRK claims the leading role in Korea's liberation, not the war. That Japan "rewrote invasion as advance" in 1982 as a blanket fact, or that the episode was a hoax. That the 38th parallel was drawn on a 1904 map, or in thirty minutes by both colonels. That the Prime Minister "skipped" Yasukuni in 2026. Each of these circulates. None survives the documents.

THE READING RULE

- 01 Read the official name of the day before the speech.
- 02 Ask which subject it removes: who acted, who lost, who is not in the sentence.
- 03 Read the speech. See whether the subject came back.

THE COUNT

0 OF SIX

Official names for the end of the Pacific war that say who drew the line across Korea.

§ SOURCES AND VERIFICATION

Open items are published, not hidden

Dated claims in this briefing trace to the documents named below. Where the record is thin, in conflict, or still awaiting a primary source, it is listed here rather than smoothed over in the text.

Open items

-
- 01 **Rusk's two dates.** The 1950 memorandum in FRUS says "the night of August 10–11"; the 1990 memoir says 14 August. Both are Rusk. The text presents both and prefers neither.
-
- 02 **Kim Il-sung's ship.** Widely named in secondary literature as the *Pugachev*. No source consulted for this briefing names it, so the text does not.
-
- 03 **DPRK textbook revisions since 2024.** Reunification content has visibly been removed from monuments, agencies and the anthem. No primary or monitoring document confirming specific textbook changes about 1945 or "one nation" was obtained. The briefing makes no claim about them.
-
- 04 **Yasukuni headcount, 15 August 2026.** Resolved: Jiji, Kyodo and NHK name four ministers.
-
- 05 **Truman's proclamation of 2 September.** Resolved: Public Papers No. 122, 1 September 1945.
-
- 06 **Weizsäcker and "Tag der Befreiung."** He did not coin the phrase; the GDR used it officially. The text credits him with carrying it into the Federal Republic's mainstream, nothing more.
-
- 07 **Korean and Japanese lines.** Native-speaker review of all original-script terms is pending. Standing rule for this imprint.
-
- 08 **Russian and Chinese designation dates.** Resolved: Federal Law 126-FZ of 24 April 2020, and the NPC Standing Committee decision of 27 February 2014.
-
- 09 **Soviet entry into Pyongyang.** The study cited gives 24 August; some histories give the 25th.
-
- 10 **Sankei, July and September 1982.** The paper's 1982 archive is not online; the Diet record of 30 July 1982 confirms the substance.
-
- 11 **Rusk's memoir.** Quoted at second hand, through National Geographic (2013); the passage has not been checked against the book.
-

Primary documents

- FRUS** Foreign Relations of the United States, 1945, vol. VI: doc 450 (Stalin to Truman, 16 Aug 1945); doc 452 (Truman to Stalin, 17/18 Aug); doc 470 (Stalin to Truman, 22 Aug); doc 476 (Byrnes's draft, 25 Aug); doc 771 (editorial note quoting Rusk to Noble, 12 Jul 1950); doc 776 (MacArthur, Proclamation No. 1). history.state.gov.
- SCHNABEL** James F. Schnabel, *Policy and Direction: The First Year* (US Army Center of Military History, 1972), pp. 9–10. apps.dtic.mil.
- RUSK** Dean Rusk, *As I Saw It* (Norton, 1990), as quoted by National Geographic (5 Aug 2013) and NK News (2012).
- JAPAN** Cabinet decisions of 14 May 1963 and 13 Apr 1982; Ministry of Health, Labour and Welfare, 全国戦没者追悼式; Imperial Rescript on the Termination of the War (14 Aug 1945); Chief Cabinet Secretary Miyazawa statement (26 Aug 1982), MOFA Diplomatic Bluebook 1983; cabinet-approved written answer on terminology (27 Apr 2021); MEXT textbook screening results (24 Mar 2026); Diet records of 30 Jul 1982 and 23 May 2001; Prime Minister's addresses of 2012, 2025 and 2026 (kantei.go.jp).
- ROK** 국경일에 관한 법률 (Act on National Holidays, promulgated 1 Oct 1949); Constitution of the Republic of Korea, preamble; Encyclopedia of Korean Culture (AKS), 광복절; Dong-A Ilbo (27 May 1949); Constituent Assembly record (3 Jun 1948).
- DPRK / RUSSIA** Rodong Sinmun and KCNA, 14–15 Aug 2024, 2025, 2026, as carried by NK News and Reuters; Kremlin, law of 24 Jun 2023 (en.kremlin.ru/acts/news/71506); the bill's explanatory note, as reported by RFE/RL; Federal Law 126-FZ (24 Apr 2020).
- GERMANY** Richard von Weizsäcker, address to the Bundestag, 8 May 1985, official text (bundestag.de); Institut für Zeitgeschichte, description of its edition, *Akten zur Auswärtigen Politik der Bundesrepublik Deutschland 1985*.
- US** Harry S. Truman, radio address of 1 Sep 1945 (Public Papers No. 122); General Order No. 1; Rhode Island General Laws, Victory Day.
- TREATIES** Treaty of San Francisco (1951); Austrian State Treaty (15 May 1955); Okinawa Reversion Agreement (1971).

Scholarship and reporting

- Bruce Cumings, *The Origins of the Korean War*, vol. 1 (Princeton, 1981). Tsuyoshi Hasegawa, *Racing the Enemy* (Harvard, 2005), with the counter-arguments of Sadao Asada (Pacific Historical Review, 1998) and Richard B. Frank (*Downfall*, 1999) on the Soviet entry versus the bombs. Gi-Wook Shin and Daniel C. Snider, eds., *History Textbooks and the Wars in Asia: Divided Memories* (Routledge). Andrei Lankov, *From Stalin to Kim Il Sung* (Hurst, 2002), on the 88th Brigade.
- Satō Takumi and Fukuma Yoshiaki on the 1982 reporting; Shoji Jun'ichirō, *Japan Review* 2(1), JIIA, 2018. University of Washington, *Kim Il Sung and the DPRK-USSR-PRC Triangle*. HRNK Insider, Apr 2021. Review of Korean Studies 16(1) on the July 1945 origin of the line.
- Aju News (15 Aug 2026); Kyodo, Jiji and NHK (15 Aug 2026); Manila Bulletin (16 Aug 2026); Korea.net, JoongAng Daily, Japan Times (15 Aug 2026); SBS (Aug 2026); Korea Herald (15 Aug 2025, full text of the Liberation Day address); JoongAng Daily (15 Aug 2024); Seoul Shinmun (18 Aug 2016; 24 Mar 2026); Seoul Economic Daily (24–25 Mar 2026); Hankyoreh (12 Sep 2008); Hankook Ilbo (13 Aug 2008); Asahi Shimbun (19 Sep 1982); Sakurai Yoshiko, GQ Japan (Apr 2001); Nikkan Kogyo Shimbun, 産業春秋 column; Nikkei (15 Aug 2023); Malay Mail (26 Jun 2023).

§ CORRECTIONS

What this edition corrects

This is v1.0.1 of 4 October 2026. It corrects the first edition of 3 October after a check of its claims against their sources. The argument is unchanged; quotations, dates and two figures are corrected.

-
- 01 **Quotations.** Stalin's 16 August sentence is now quoted whole, with its Liaotung condition (p. 14). His 22 August cable says "you refuse", not "refusal", and is FRUS doc 470 (pp. 14–15). The Putin line is Reuters' paraphrase, not a quotation (pp. 11, 24). The Korean preamble is quoted verbatim (p. 8). Seoul said in 2026 that it "cannot but deplore" the Yasukuni visits; "deep regret" was the 2025 wording (p. 23).
-
- 02 **Fig. 08.** The arrows pointed the 1950 memorandum at "thirty minutes" and the memoir at "10 August". Superscripts now name the document behind each clause (p. 18).
-
- 03 **President Lee.** He proposed talks among the two Koreas and the United States, or those three and China, not a peace regime "negotiated with Washington and Beijing" (p. 24).
-
- 04 **The 15 August addresses.** From 2013 they dropped remorse and the acknowledgement of harm to Asian countries; the 2012 address did not say "aggression" either. "Remorse" appears in two addresses of fifteen, 2012 and 2025 (Fig. 11). The Prime Minister spoke before the Emperor. The 2025 address is no longer used as 2026 evidence (pp. 23–25).
-
- 05 **China's name.** It contains no word for aggression; the official English adds it. The NPC Standing Committee, not the full Congress, made it statutory (Fig. 01, p. 12).
-
- 06 **Bitburg.** The quoted assessment is the Institut für Zeitgeschichte's description of its edition, not the edition itself, and it places the indignation above all in the United States (p. 19).
-
- 07 **Also corrected.** Fig. 05's dates; the 1982 chain dated and re-attributed, Asahi's line given as the question it was, Sakurai and Machimura dated; the Ninomiya text moved to the 2025 screening; Seoul's 2026 textbook response; four Yasukuni ministers named; Truman's reply on the Kurils; Pyongyang's date and the day counts; the 1949 vote, the Year 30 speeches and Han Si-jun's claim; Chung's bill withdrawn; Austria and the Kurils in Fig. 07; Fig. 03's arc; a teaching guide dropped as a source; open items 04, 05 and 08 closed; sources completed.
-
- 08 **House notes.** Two sentences about Washington are softened (pp. 2, 25); the thesis line is unchanged. The colophon now says the author writes in the first person, and discloses AI assistance.
-

Readers who find a further error can write to editor@npsi.ca. Corrections are credited.

Who ended it, who was freed, and who was cut in half are three different sentences.

38° N

COLOPHON

One Day, Four Names. NPSI Special Briefing NPSI-20261003-C, issued 3 October 2026 by the North Pacific Strategy Initiative, Victoria, British Columbia; corrected edition v1.0.1, 4 October 2026. Author of record: Jesse James, Founding Editor.

METHOD

Dated claims were traced to named documents before drafting, and checked against them again for the corrected edition. Where a widely repeated claim rested on a single or erroneous origin, the chain is shown rather than the claim repeated. The author writes in the first person; passages of opinion say so. Researched and drafted with substantial assistance from AI systems, principally Claude, made by Anthropic; the author is responsible for the text.

SET IN

Source Serif 4, Source Sans 3, JetBrains Mono. Dark edition for distribution, cream edition for print. Figures are original to this briefing; coastlines from Natural Earth.

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